



GoogleSync

Now available on Symbian; use it to easily sync your Google contacts and Google calendar with your Series 60 3rd edition devices



Sync online calendars

with Dropbox. Simply use Rainlendar Calendar and place the .ics file of the calendar in the Dropbox folder

Ashwini Bavskar



Synchronicity

We show you how you can automatically sync files and folders between two or more PCs using simple applications. We include a low-down on what each of these services has to offer, and which one is best suited to your needs

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Most of us find ourselves working on at least two PCs in the course of our personal or professional lives; be it a combination of notebook and office desktop, or the good old home PC and the notebook which you take to work. Let's face it – parts of your digital world are scattered all over the place and there ought to be a way to get it all together. Nothing can be worse than showing up at the office and realising that you left the most recent copy of that important presentation at home. Working on different machines brings with it the headache of keeping track of versions and having the latest files updated on all PCs, at all times. Sure, you have the

option of carrying files on a USB drive and manually updating tons of data. But that's cumbersome. What you need is a way to automatically sync files between PCs. Several web-based services allow you to do just that. All you need is an internet connection and you will soon find yourself exhausting lesser brain cells figuring out which PC has the latest version of which file. Here, we show you which are the best options available out there and how to use

them. You can then choose a solution to fit your needs.

Windows Live Sync [sync.live.com] Simplicity for the novice user

This is a simple service to use and thankfully you don't need to create yet another email ID with Hotmail or MSN in order to use it. You can use your existing email to register with the service or use your MSN/Hotmail Live ID if you already have one. Once you complete registration, you will be directed to a download page. Once you download and run the small client you can specify which folders to sync via a web interface. Install the application on any other computer with which you wish to sync files and point the application to the corresponding folder. The web interface is easy to use but of course simplicity has its limitations. LiveSync works only with Mac and Windows, so Linux users will have to look at other alternatives. Other than that, both the syncing computers have to be turned on for a sync to take place. Unlike some other services in this realm, Live Sync doesn't keep a copy of your files in the cloud, which you can then access without the client. This however has an upside – no data limits. So go ahead and sync away to your heart's content. You can even enable remote access through Live Sync. Remote access allows you to browse through the computer's hard disk remotely. But since this is essentially a P2P application which sends information via the internet, enabling this is not recommended. By default, remote access is disabled.

Live Mesh [mesh.com] Not meshy at all

Another Microsoft web offering; this one however is quite promising. Apart from syncing files and folders it also merges them with the cloud. So, instead of synchronising files between PCs directly, you create folders in the "Mesh", and then have your PCs



Add devices to the Mesh by installing the client on each machine